

Symbat Ussupova

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EDUCATION

ASTANA IT UNIVERSITY

*Bachelor of Science in Information and Communication Technologies,
Media Technologies*

Astana, Kazakhstan
September 2021 – June 2024

- Government-funded Full-Ride Merit scholarship
- GPA: 3.75/4.0 (Honors Diploma)
- Thesis: "The influence of the media on the formation of public opinion in the context of military conflicts." Supervisor: Aidiye Aidarbekov. Comparative content analysis and frame analysis of Russian-Ukrainian war coverage across four countries; accompanied by an original 2D animated short film
- Relevant Coursework: Research Methods and Tools, Academic Writing, Directing for Media Projects, Screenwriting, UI/UX Design, 3D Animation, Game Development

OMNIUM CENTER OF INTERACTIVE TECHNOLOGIES AND EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMS

GameDev Teams Incubation Program (Pipeline 3.0)

Astana, Kazakhstan

Professional Certification: Certified as a 3D Artist, 2D Artist, and Animator

September 2024 – July 2025

- Key Achievement: Co-founded the indie team Coldlight Games during the program to develop "Pharos," a mobile game prototype
- Awards: Won "Best Visual" and "Best Storytelling" awards at the Final Demo Day among all incubation participants

PUBLICATIONS

Aidarbekov, A., Ussupova, S., & Baizhuminova, B. (2024). Analysis of media manipulation strategies during military conflicts. In Proceedings of the 6th International Scientific Conference "Academics and Science Reviews Materials" (May 2–3, 2024), Helsinki, Finland. ISBN 978-7-1320-0759-6.

Kantayeva, A., & Ussupova, S. (2022). The features of the TCP/IP layers. In Modern Research and Development, 55–58.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

CONTEXTA – AI System for Detecting Media Manipulation

July 2026 – August 2026

Co-creator | UNESCO Youth Hackathon

- Built a working prototype that analyzes English and Russian news texts for framing and manipulation. The system returns the flagged quote, identified tactic, intensity level, and a detailed explanation, rather than a binary "true/false" verdict
- Operationalized a taxonomy of 9 media manipulation tactics based on existing academic literature (synthesizing 40+ studies), defining clear detection criteria and linguistic markers tailored to English and Russian political discourse
- Engineered LLM constraints to reduce false positives by writing counterexamples for every tactic, effectively teaching the AI to distinguish intentional manipulation from standard journalistic practices
- Implemented source-attribution logic that separates an outlet's own editorial framing from the rhetoric of the sources it quotes
- Designed an LLM-based analysis layer with structured prompt parameters, automated workflows, and a web front-end

UNDERGRADUATE THESIS RESEARCH

Astana IT University

September 2023 – June 2024

- Conducted a mixed-methods comparative study of Russian-Ukrainian war coverage across eight state and independent outlets. The purposive sample represented direct conflict participants (Ukraine, Russia), a regional neighbor (Kazakhstan), and global Western media (UK)
- Designed a purposive sampling strategy based on four impact criteria and a two-period design to capture the initial invasion and the subsequent lull, selecting a final corpus of 22 articles
- Developed a five-dimension qualitative frame matrix, coding each article for its core position, rhetoric, problem source, implied solution, and attributed proposition
- Produced an original 2D animated short film as the practical component

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HAILEYBURY ASTANA

Communications Specialist

Astana, Kazakhstan

April 2026 – Present

- Develop and execute institutional communication strategies across Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, and the school website to strengthen brand visibility
- Produce multimedia content, including photography, videography, interviews, and event coverage for school communications
- Mentor and supervise high school students in marketing, communications, and media projects, guiding their hands-on skill development
- Coordinate communication campaigns with academic departments, admissions, and leadership teams
- Support media relations and internal communications for school initiatives and community events

COMRUN RE:KASSA

Account Manager

Astana, Kazakhstan

February 2026 – April 2026

- Manage the full lifecycle of a high-value partner portfolio, serving as the primary point of contact
- Execute strategic meetings to align service delivery with client business goals and KPIs
- Optimize documentation workflows and client data management using amoCRM

BAYER CROP SCIENCE KAZAKHSTAN

Marketing Intern

Astana, Kazakhstan

September 2024 – September 2025

- Localized global communication strategies for the Kazakhstani market and managed the corporate social media presence
- Collaborated with international teams to design print and digital assets, ensuring brand compliance
- Coordinated communications between international teams and local sales to align materials with business needs
- Organized large-scale marketing events and product launches for nationwide distributors, and project-led the "Tilashar" corporate initiative promoting the Kazakh language

SIMPLE STUDIO

Graphic Designer / SMM Intern

Astana, Kazakhstan

March 2024 – May 2024

- Developed comprehensive branding and advertising strategies for BTCS Creative School
- Produced banners and promotional videos for city-wide LED screen advertisements
- Designed high-converting visual assets for targeted campaigns

KAZMEDIA ORTALYGY, TV CHANNEL «KHABAR»

Scriptwriter & Video Editing Intern

Astana, Kazakhstan

March 2023 – April 2023

- Wrote scripts for animated video content
- Edited promotional and review content for national television

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

COLDLIGHT GAMES

Co-Founder / 3D Artist / Scriptwriter

Astana, Kazakhstan

January 2025 – Present

- Lead cross-functional teams (artists, developers, designers) to meet critical project milestones
- Awarded 2nd Place Overall at RAID Game Jam 2025 and Top 10 in "Best Game on Solana" category
- Design 3D assets, environments, and game narratives for mobile prototypes

BAYER CROP SCIENCE

Astana, Kazakhstan

Volunteer, Project Lead for "TILASHAR" (Kazakh Language Initiative) January 2025 – September 2025

- Spearheaded a corporate initiative to promote the Kazakh language through educational digital content

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Technical: Blender, Autodesk Maya, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Premiere Pro, Substance Painter), Figma, KIT Scenarist

Language: Kazakh (Native), Russian (Fluent), English (Advanced)

Interests: Digital Art & Animation, Game Design & Development, Media Theory, Cinematography, Creative Writing, New Technologies in Creative Industries